



Introduction to Artificial Intelligence (INTRAI)

Module 1: What is AI?

History, Myths and Limits

Lesson Notes

KMVTECHUG

Version: 2026

A Short History

The name artificial intelligence was popularised at a 1956 research workshop. Early researchers were optimistic that human-level intelligence was close. Progress was real, but harder than expected.

High funding periods were followed by AI winters when results lagged promises. Later waves brought expert systems, machine learning with more data and computing, then deep learning and large language models.

For a student, the lesson is that AI advances in cycles. Tools improve, limits remain, and practical value depends on data, computing, and careful design - not only on slogans.

Myths vs Reality

Myth: AI is always neutral. Reality: systems learn from data, so biased data can produce unfair outputs.

Myth: AI understands the world like humans. Reality: most systems match patterns and lack full human common sense.

Myth: confident wording means truth. Reality: generative tools can sound fluent and still be wrong.

Myth: AI replaces every job next year. Reality: some tasks change; judgment and domain skill remain valuable.

What AI Can and Cannot Do

AI is often good at spotting patterns in large data, ranking options, translation, and speeding routine digital work.

AI is often weak when there is little relevant data, when deep local context is missing, when moral responsibility is required, or when truth must be guaranteed.

On campus, AI can help draft an outline or simplify a concept. It cannot replace your duty for accurate citations, honest coursework, or professional ethics later.

Reflect: Which myth about AI have you heard most often among classmates, and what is the better framing?

Closing

Treat AI as a powerful tool class - narrow, data-driven, useful when checked - not as a magical authority. Module 2 explains the data to prediction pipeline.